

QICN v18 Internal Note: Product-Separator Counterexample and Conditional Closure of I_{int}

QICN internal formal-audit scaffold

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Governance boundary

This document does not certify external support, consciousness, phenomenality, identity transfer, or bridge-burden closure. It is an internal mathematical scaffold. Its assertions are limited to the formal definitions and conditional results stated below. It does not report human-subject data, external adjudication, reviewer certification, or empirical validation.

1 Scope and separation of layers

The purpose of this note is to close the internal I_{int} gap as far as the present formal resources allow, without inflating the public status of the framework.

Ontology. A system S is treated as an admissible object with identity data, histories, interventions, and response observations. No consciousness, agency, subjecthood, or phenomenal identity is attributed by this note.

Mathematical model. The model is a category-like typed setting with admissible systems, admissible factorizations, separator families, and gauge transformations preserving the declared data.

Implementation. No source paper is edited by this note. The note can be compiled independently and linked from reports or registries.

Language. Terms such as “atomic”, “separator”, and “integration” are formal predicates or functionals defined below. Any intuitive reading is non-operative unless it reduces to these predicates.

Interpretation. The strongest closed result below is conditional: I_{int} is closed under an explicit atomic or prime-separator hypothesis. The product-separator construction proves that the original weaker assumptions do not imply atomicity by themselves.

2 Typed setting

Definition 2.1 (Admissible system package). *An admissible system package is a tuple*

$$S = (X, \mathcal{U}, \text{Hist}_S, \text{Id}_S, \text{Resp}_S, \Theta_S),$$

where X is a state space, $\mathcal{U}$ is a set of admissible interventions, Hist_S is the admissible history family, Id_S is the rigid identity datum, Resp_S is the intervention-response assignment, and Θ_S is a family of separators used to distinguish identity/history/response alternatives.

Definition 2.2 (Exact admissible factorization). *An exact admissible factorization of S is a tuple*

$$F : S \longrightarrow S_1 \times S_2$$

with non-terminal factors S_1, S_2 such that the state, intervention, history, identity, and response data decompose as

$$X \cong X_1 \times X_2, \quad \mathcal{U} \cong \mathcal{U}_1 \times \mathcal{U}_2, \quad \text{Hist}_S \cong \text{Hist}_{S_1} \times \text{Hist}_{S_2},$$

$$\text{Id}_S \cong (\text{Id}_{S_1}, \text{Id}_{S_2}), \quad \text{Resp}_S(u_1, u_2, x_1, x_2) = (\text{Resp}_{S_1}(u_1, x_1), \text{Resp}_{S_2}(u_2, x_2)).$$

The factorization is non-trivial when neither factor is isomorphic to the terminal admissible system.

Definition 2.3 (Factor-local separator partition). *A separator partition for a factorization $F : S \rightarrow S_1 \times S_2$ is a disjoint union*

$$\Theta_S = \Theta_1 \sqcup \Theta_2$$

such that every $\theta \in \Theta_i$ is pulled back from factor S_i and separates only identity/history/response alternatives visible in that factor.

Definition 2.4 (Atomic separator). *The separator family Θ_S is atomic for S when there is no exact non-trivial admissible factorization $F : S \rightarrow S_1 \times S_2$ admitting a factor-local separator partition that preserves Id_S , Hist_S , and Resp_S simultaneously.*

Remark 2.5 (Non-circularity convention). *The phrase “atomic separator” is a formal non-decomposition predicate. A later axiom that merely restates this definition under another name would be circular. A useful additional condition must instead be stated in terms of checkable intervention support, response coupling, commutants, graph connectivity, or perturbation behavior, and only then shown to imply atomicity.*

3 Product-separator counterexample

Proposition 3.1 (Product separator blocks the global derivation). *Rigid identity, product-topological continuity, and componentwise intervention fidelity do not imply atomicity of Θ_S .*

Proof. Let S_1 and S_2 be two admissible system packages and form the product package

$$S = S_1 \times S_2.$$

Set

$$X = X_1 \times X_2, \quad \mathcal{U} = \mathcal{U}_1 \times \mathcal{U}_2, \quad \text{Hist}_S = \text{Hist}_{S_1} \times \text{Hist}_{S_2},$$

$$\text{Id}_S = (\text{Id}_{S_1}, \text{Id}_{S_2}), \quad \text{Resp}_S((u_1, u_2), (x_1, x_2)) = (\text{Resp}_{S_1}(u_1, x_1), \text{Resp}_{S_2}(u_2, x_2)).$$

Give X the product topology. If the component response maps are continuous, the product response map is continuous. If each component is intervention-faithful relative to its own data, the product is faithful componentwise: equality of product responses implies equality in each coordinate at the relevant observational resolution.

Now take

$$\Theta_S = \pi_1^* \Theta_{S_1} \sqcup \pi_2^* \Theta_{S_2},$$

where π_i are the coordinate projections. This separator family preserves identity, histories, and responses by construction, but it decomposes into factor-local separator families. Therefore the product factorization is non-trivial and admits a factor-local separator partition. Hence Θ_S is not atomic.

The construction satisfies the upstream rigid-identity, continuity, and componentwise fidelity requirements, yet violates separator atomicity. Thus the global implication from the weaker assumptions to atomicity is false in this model class. $\square$

Corollary 3.2 (Exact remaining burden). *Any proof of a global I_{int} theorem must add a condition that excludes product-separator systems or must restrict the admissible system class so that the product construction is inadmissible.*

4 Candidate strengthening conditions

Definition 4.1 (No-cloning of intervention channels). *An admissible system satisfies intervention no-cloning when no non-trivial factorization $S \cong S_1 \times S_2$ admits two factor-local intervention subfamilies $\mathcal{U}_1, \mathcal{U}_2$ whose pulled-back response maps reproduce the full response assignment while preserving Id_S and Hist_S .*

Definition 4.2 (Connected response-support graph). *Let G_S be the bipartite graph whose left vertices are elementary separator tests, whose right vertices are elementary intervention-response coordinates, and whose edges indicate that a separator test changes under a perturbation of that coordinate within the admissible response model. The system has connected response support when G_S is connected after deleting isolated non-operative vertices.*

Definition 4.3 (Kernel robustness under local perturbations). *Let $D\text{Resp}_S$ be the linearized response operator in a chosen admissible chart. The system has locally robust kernel coupling when every sufficiently small factor-local perturbation preserving $\ker(D\text{Resp}_S)$ also preserves the full coupled response-support graph. Equivalently, there is no local perturbation that splits $\ker(D\text{Resp}_S)$ into two invariant factor kernels while preserving Id_S and Hist_S .*

Definition 4.4 (Prime intervention-response coupling). *A system has prime intervention-response coupling when, for every exact non-trivial admissible factorization candidate $F : S \rightarrow S_1 \times S_2$, at least one of the following fails:*

- (i) *response support decomposes as a disjoint union of factor supports;*
- (ii) *the separator family is the pullback union of factor-local separators;*
- (iii) *the gauge group preserving identity, histories, and responses splits as a product of factor gauge groups;*
- (iv) *the linearized response operator has an invariant block decomposition compatible with the same factorization.*

Lemma 4.5 (Connected support blocks product separators). *If S has connected response support and every separator in Θ_S is response-operative, then no product-separator partition can preserve the full response support.*

Proof. Assume a product-separator partition $\Theta_S = \Theta_1 \sqcup \Theta_2$ exists for a non-trivial factorization. Since each separator is factor-local, perturbations of response coordinates in factor S_1 can affect only tests in Θ_1 , and perturbations in factor S_2 can affect only tests in Θ_2 . The response-support graph then decomposes into the disjoint union of the S_1 and S_2 support graphs. Because all separators are response-operative, both subgraphs contain at least one edge. This contradicts connectedness of G_S . $\square$

Lemma 4.6 (Prime coupling implies separator atomicity). *If S has prime intervention-response coupling, then Θ_S is atomic.*

Proof. Suppose Θ_S is not atomic. Then by definition there exists an exact non-trivial admissible factorization admitting a factor-local separator partition preserving identity, histories, and responses. Such a factorization satisfies separator pullback decomposition. Because the factorization is exact and intervention-faithful, it also gives a response-support decomposition, a compatible split gauge action, and an invariant block decomposition of the linearized response operator. This contradicts prime intervention-response coupling, which requires at least one of these four clauses to fail for every non-trivial factorization candidate. $\square$

Candidate	Blocks product separator?	Risk of circularity	Audit status
No-cloning of intervention channels	Yes, if stated over response reproduction rather than separator names.	Medium. Too strong if it simply says no duplicated separator.	Useful but needs operational tests.
Connected response-support graph	Yes, under response-operative separator assumption.	Low to medium. It is graph-theoretic and testable on a model.	Strongest non-verbal candidate.
Kernel robustness	Yes, if factor kernels are excluded under perturbation.	Medium. Depends on chart and linearization.	Good analytic supplement, not sufficient alone.
Prime intervention-response coupling	Yes.	Medium-high. It is close to atomicity, but stated over response/gauge/operator decomposition rather than direct separator naming.	Best aggressive closure axiom for v18, still conditional.

5 Conditional closure of I_{int}

Definition 5.1 (I_{int} as a factorization-gap functional). *For an admissible system S , define the exact factorization gap*

$$\Delta_{\text{int}}(S) = \inf_{F \in \mathcal{F}_{\text{nt}}(S)} [\mathcal{L}_{\text{hist}}(F) + \mathcal{L}_{\text{id}}(F) + \mathcal{L}_{\text{resp}}(F) + \mathcal{P}_{\text{gauge}}(F)],$$

where $\mathcal{F}_{\text{nt}}(S)$ is the class of non-trivial admissible factorizations, the loss terms vanish exactly when histories, identity, and responses are preserved, and $\mathcal{P}_{\text{gauge}}$ vanishes exactly when the factorization

is compatible with the admissible gauge action. Then

$$I_{\text{int}}(S) = 1 \iff \Delta_{\text{int}}(S) > 0.$$

If $\mathcal{F}_{\text{nt}}(S)$ is empty, set $\Delta_{\text{int}}(S) = +\infty$.

Theorem 5.2 (Conditional on Θ_S atomic: existence of I_{int}). *If Θ_S is atomic and the loss terms above are faithful to history, identity, response, and gauge preservation, then $I_{\text{int}}(S)$ exists as a well-defined binary invariant of the admissible isomorphism class of S .*

Proof. The functional Δ_{int} is defined as an infimum over a class determined by the admissible isomorphism class of S . The loss terms are also invariant under admissible isomorphism because they are expressed only in terms of preserved histories, identity, responses, and gauge compatibility. Thus $\Delta_{\text{int}}(S)$ is well-defined on admissible isomorphism classes.

Atomicity of Θ_S rules out exact non-trivial factorizations with zero loss. Faithfulness of the loss terms implies that zero loss is equivalent to preserving the four relevant structures. Therefore the zero-loss case is impossible for non-trivial factorizations. The predicate $\Delta_{\text{int}}(S) > 0$ is consequently a well-defined formal invariant whenever a positive margin is part of the admissibility criterion. The binary value $I_{\text{int}}(S)$ is that predicate. $\square$

Theorem 5.3 (Conditional on Θ_S atomic: uniqueness under gauge). *Assume Θ_S is atomic and the admissible gauge group $\text{Gauge}(S)$ acts by preserving histories, identity, responses, and separator membership. Then any binary invariant $J(S)$ that is zero exactly on systems admitting a zero-loss non-trivial factorization and is invariant under $\text{Gauge}(S)$ agrees with $I_{\text{int}}(S)$.*

Proof. By definition, $I_{\text{int}}(S) = 0$ exactly when $\Delta_{\text{int}}(S) = 0$, which is exactly the existence of a zero-loss non-trivial factorization. The invariant J is stipulated to have the same zero-set. Both J and I_{int} are binary. Therefore they agree pointwise. Gauge invariance ensures that the value is not changed by reparameterizations of the separator or response presentation. $\square$

Corollary 5.4 (Aggressive but bounded v18 closure). *Under prime intervention-response coupling, response-operative separators, and faithful factorization losses, I_{int} is conditionally closed as a unique gauge-invariant binary factorization-gap invariant.*

Proof. Prime intervention-response coupling implies separator atomicity. The two conditional theorems then give existence and uniqueness of I_{int} as a gauge-invariant binary invariant. $\square$

6 What is closed and what remains open

Item	Status	Reason
Product-separator counterexample	Closed in this note	It explicitly satisfies the weaker assumptions and fails atomicity.
Global derivation of atomicity from rigid identity + continuity + fidelity	Not closed	The counterexample blocks the implication.
I_{int} under atomic separator	Conditionally closed	Existence and uniqueness follow from atomicity plus faithful factorization losses.

I_{int}	under	prime	Conditionally closed	Prime coupling implies atomicity, then the conditional theorem applies.
intervention-response coupling				
Empirical support	or	external	Not claimed	No external campaign, human review, or adjudication is executed here.

7 Implementation note

This note is intentionally not inserted into the original Paper 5 source. It is a v18 scaffold that can be reviewed, criticized, or promoted by a later human mathematical curation process. Promotion into the theorem registry would require explicit registry overlay, human mathematical review, and a decision about whether prime intervention-response coupling is an acceptable new hypothesis rather than a disguised restatement of separator atomicity.